

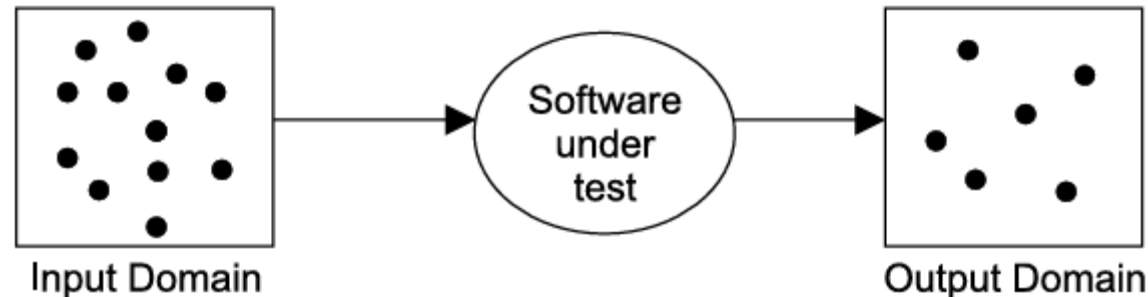
# BlackBox Testig

# 1. Introduction to Functional Testing

- Functional testing is a **black-box testing** technique. This means the tester has no knowledge of the internal code or design of the system. The focus is solely on what the system is supposed to do, based on the requirements and specifications.
- **Key Characteristics:**
- **Focus on functionality:** Does the system meet the specified business and user requirements?
- **External perspective:** It's performed from the user's point of view.
- **Driven by requirements:** Test cases are derived directly from the functional requirements document.

# 1. Introduction to Functional Testing

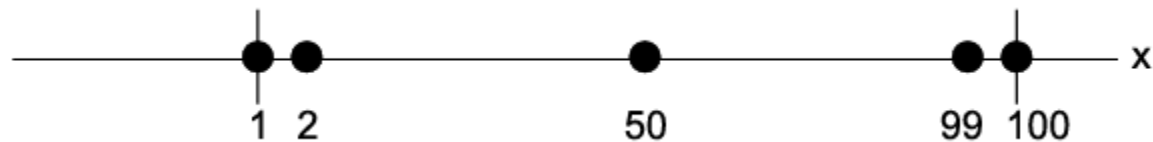
- Functional testing techniques attempt to design those test cases which have a higher probability of making a software fail.
- These techniques also attempt to test every possible functionality of the software.
- Many activities are performed in real life with only black box knowledge like driving a car, using a cell phone, operating a computer
- These techniques can be used at all levels of software testing like unit, integration, system and acceptance testing.



## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS

- Here, we concentrate on input values and design test cases with input values that are on or close to boundary values
- Experience has shown that such test cases have a higher probability of detecting a fault in the software.

- (i) Minimum value
- (ii) Just above minimum value
- (iii) Maximum value
- (iv) Just below maximum value
- (v) Nominal (Average) value



## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS

- The number of inputs selected by this technique is  $4n + 1$  where 'n' is the number of inputs.

**Table 2.1.** Test cases for the 'Square' program

| Test Case | Input x | Expected output |
|-----------|---------|-----------------|
| 1.        | 1       | 1               |
| 2.        | 2       | 4               |
| 3.        | 50      | 2500            |
| 4.        | 99      | 9801            |
| 5.        | 100     | 10000           |

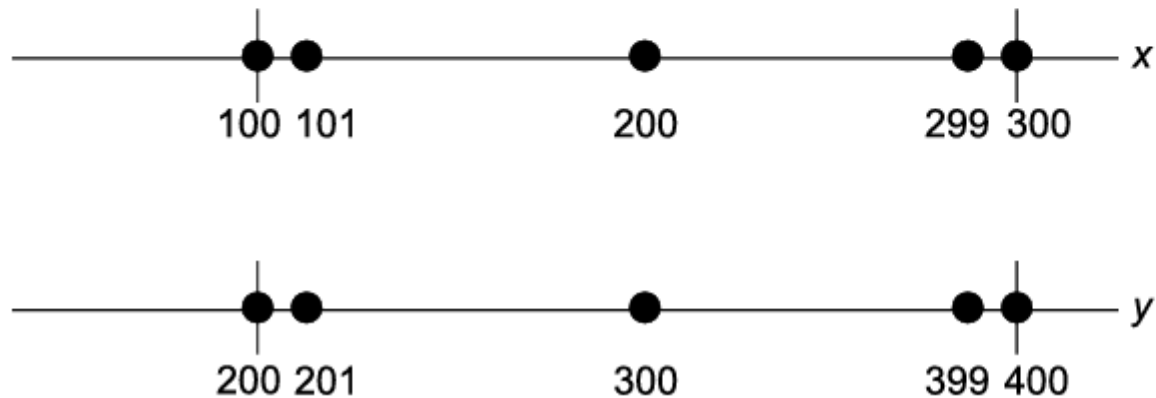
## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS

Consider a program 'Addition' with two input values  $x$  and  $y$  and it gives the addition of  $x$  and  $y$  as an output. The range of both input values are given as:

$$100 \leq x \leq 300$$

$$200 \leq y \leq 400$$

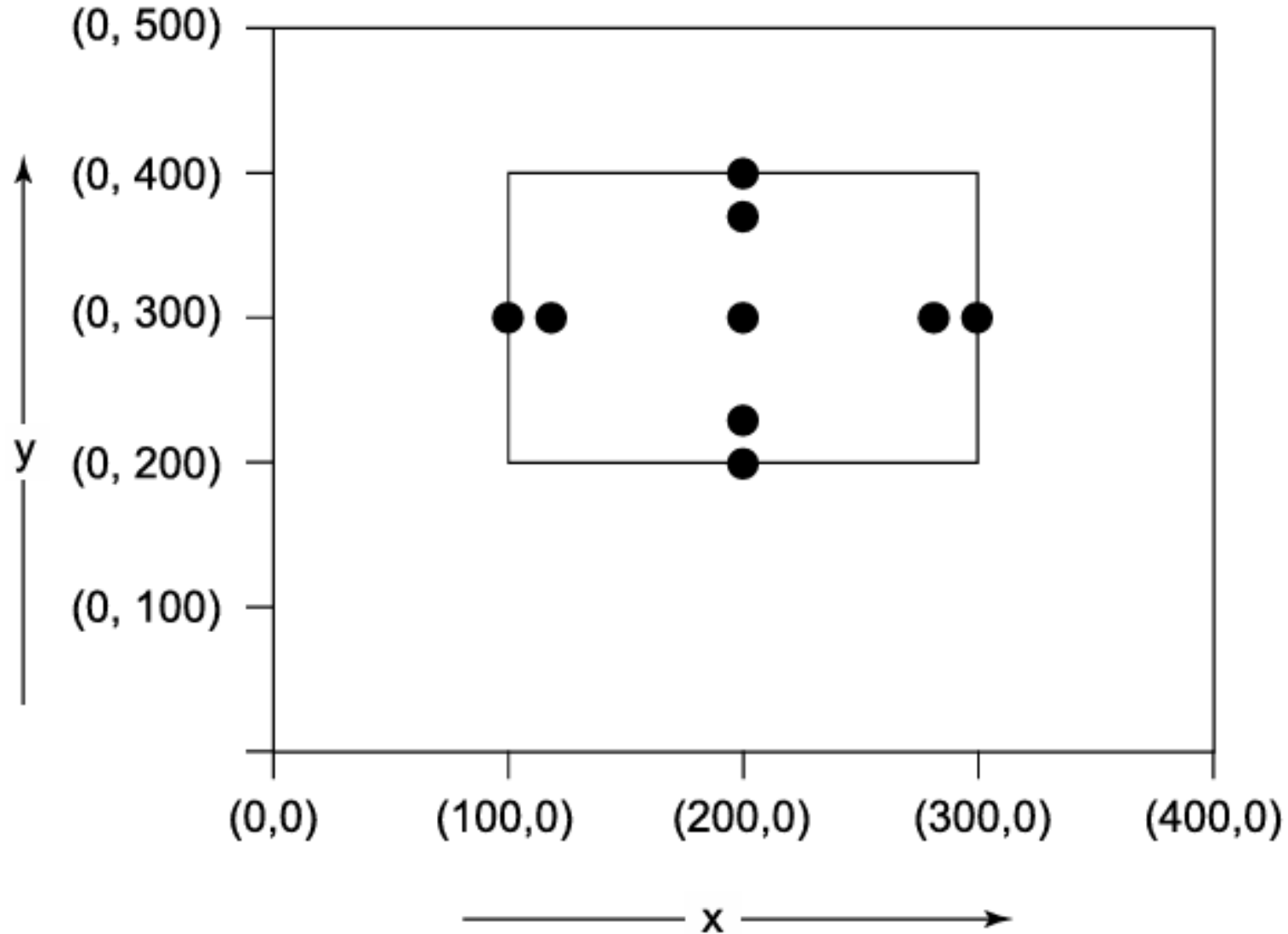
The selected values for  $x$  and  $y$  are given in Figure 2.3.



## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS

- We also consider 'single fault' assumption theory of reliability which says that failures are rarely the result of the simultaneous occurrence of two (or more) faults.
- Normally, one fault is responsible for one failure. With this theory in mind, we select one input value on
  - boundary (minimum)
  - just above boundary (minimum +)
  - just below boundary (maximum -)
  - on boundary (maximum)
  - nominal (average)

## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS





## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS

**Table 2.2.** Test cases for the program 'Addition'

| Test Case | x   | y   | Expected Output |
|-----------|-----|-----|-----------------|
| 1.        | 100 | 300 | 400             |
| 2.        | 101 | 300 | 401             |
| 3.        | 200 | 300 | 500             |
| 4.        | 299 | 300 | 599             |
| 5.        | 300 | 300 | 600             |
| 6.        | 200 | 200 | 400             |
| 7.        | 200 | 201 | 401             |
| 8.        | 200 | 300 | 500             |
| 9.        | 200 | 399 | 599             |
| 10.       | 200 | 400 | 600             |

## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS

- Consider a program for the determination of the largest amongst three numbers. Its input is a triple of positive integers (say x,y and z) and values are from interval [1, 300].

**Table 2.3. Boundary value test cases to find the largest among three numbers**

| <b>Test Case</b> | <b>x</b> | <b>y</b> | <b>z</b> | <b>Expected output</b> |
|------------------|----------|----------|----------|------------------------|
| 1.               | 1        | 150      | 150      | 150                    |
| 2.               | 2        | 150      | 150      | 150                    |
| 3.               | 150      | 150      | 150      | 150                    |
| 4.               | 299      | 150      | 150      | 299                    |
| 5.               | 300      | 150      | 150      | 300                    |
| 6.               | 150      | 1        | 150      | 150                    |
| 7.               | 150      | 2        | 150      | 150                    |
| 8.               | 150      | 299      | 150      | 299                    |
| 9.               | 150      | 300      | 150      | 300                    |
| 10.              | 150      | 150      | 1        | 150                    |
| 11.              | 150      | 150      | 2        | 150                    |
| 12.              | 150      | 150      | 299      | 299                    |
| 13.              | 150      | 150      | 300      | 300                    |

## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS

**Example 2.2:** Consider a program for the determination of division of a student based on the marks in three subjects. Its input is a triple of positive integers (say mark1, mark2, and mark3) and values are from interval [0, 100].

The division is calculated according to the following rules:

| Marks Obtained<br>(Average) | Division                        |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 75 – 100                    | First Division with distinction |
| 60 – 74                     | First division                  |
| 50 – 59                     | Second division                 |
| 40 – 49                     | Third division                  |
| 0 – 39                      | Fail                            |

Total marks obtained are the average of marks obtained in the three subjects i.e.

$$\text{Average} = (\text{mark1} + \text{mark 2} + \text{mark3}) / 3$$

The program output may have one of the following words:

[Fail, Third Division, Second Division, First Division, First Division with Distinction]

Design the boundary value test cases.

## 2.1 BOUNDARY VALUE ANALYSIS

**Table 2.4.** Boundary value test cases for the program determining the division of a student

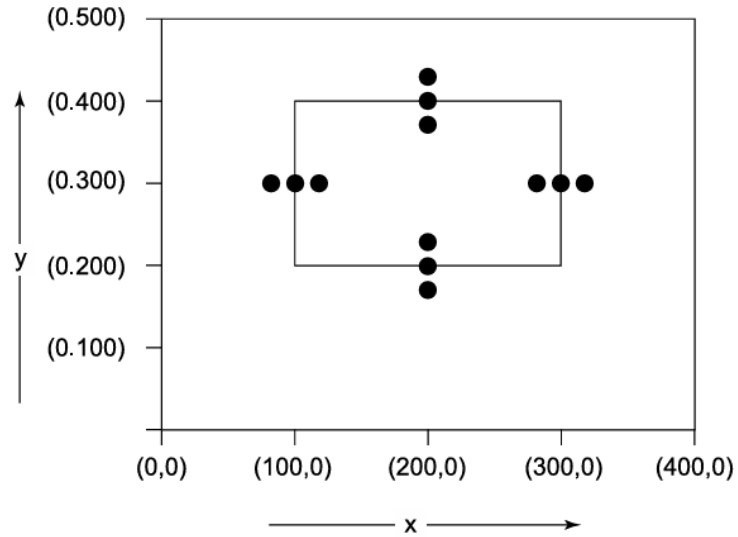
| <b>Test Case</b> | <b>mark1</b> | <b>mark2</b> | <b>mark3</b> | <b>Expected Output</b> |
|------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|------------------------|
| 1.               | 0            | 50           | 50           | Fail                   |
| 2.               | 1            | 50           | 50           | Fail                   |
| 3.               | 50           | 50           | 50           | Second Division        |
| 4.               | 99           | 50           | 50           | First Division         |
| 5.               | 100          | 50           | 50           | First Division         |

| <b>Test Case</b> | <b>mark1</b> | <b>mark2</b> | <b>mark3</b> | <b>Expected Output</b> |
|------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|------------------------|
| 6.               | 50           | 0            | 50           | Fail                   |
| 7.               | 50           | 1            | 50           | Fail                   |
| 8.               | 50           | 99           | 50           | First Division         |
| 9.               | 50           | 100          | 50           | First Division         |
| 10.              | 50           | 50           | 0            | Fail                   |
| 11.              | 50           | 50           | 1            | Fail                   |
| 12.              | 50           | 50           | 99           | First Division         |
| 13.              | 50           | 50           | 100          | First Division         |

## 2.1.1 ROBUSTNESS TESTING

- This is the extension of boundary value analysis.
- Here, we also select invalid values and see the responses of the program.
- Hence, two additional states are added i.e. just below minimum value (minimum value–) and just above maximum value (maximum value +).
- Thus, the total test cases in robustness testing are  $6n + 1$ , where 'n' is the number of input values.
  - (i) Minimum value
  - (ii) Just above minimum value
  - (iii) Just below minimum value
  - (iv) Just above maximum value
  - (v) Just below maximum value
  - (vi) Maximum value
  - (vii) Nominal (Average) value

## 2.1.1 ROBUSTNESS TESTING



**Table 2.7. Robustness test cases for two input values x and y**

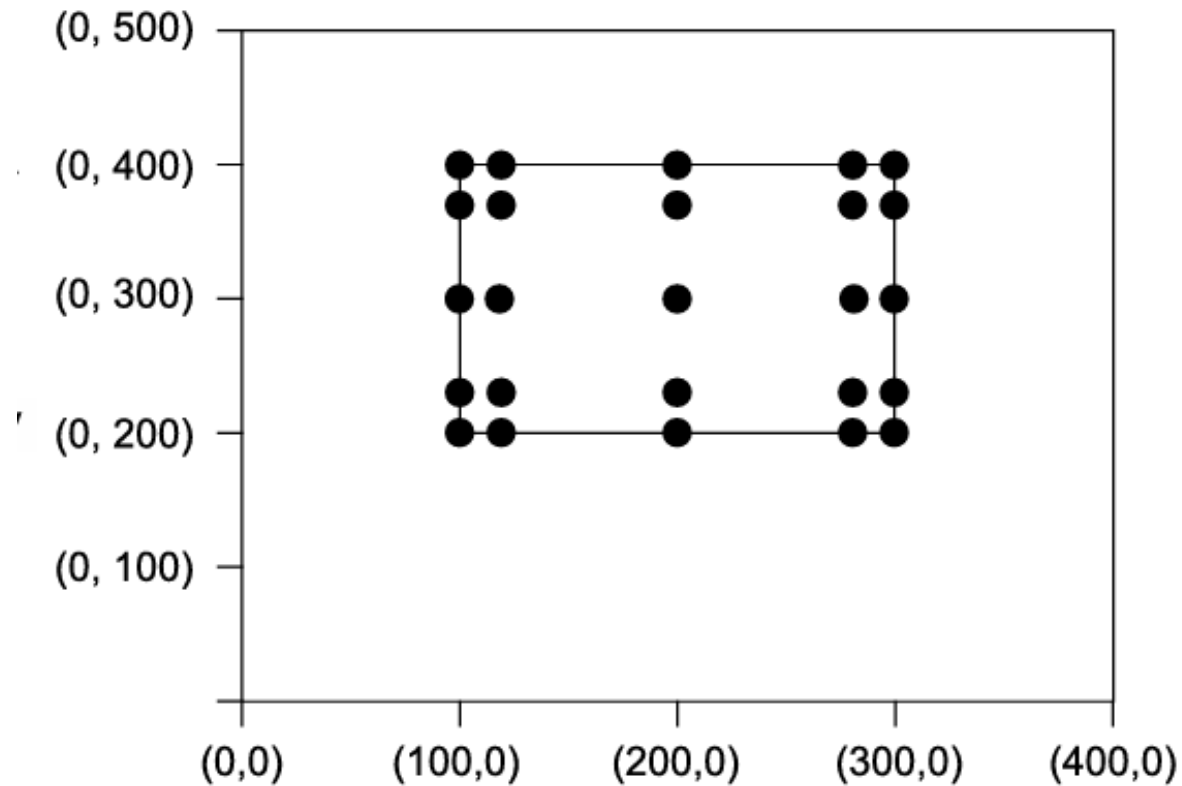
| Test Case | x   | y   | Expected Output |
|-----------|-----|-----|-----------------|
| 1.        | 99  | 300 | Invalid Input   |
| 2.        | 100 | 300 | 400             |
| 3.        | 101 | 300 | 401             |
| 4.        | 200 | 300 | 500             |
| 5.        | 299 | 300 | 599             |
| 6.        | 300 | 300 | 600             |
| 7.        | 301 | 300 | Invalid Input   |
| 8.        | 200 | 199 | Invalid Input   |
| 9.        | 200 | 200 | 400             |
| 10.       | 200 | 201 | 401             |
| 11.       | 200 | 399 | 599             |
| 12.       | 200 | 400 | 600             |
| 13.       | 200 | 401 | Invalid Input   |

## 2.1.2 Worst-Case Testing

- This is a special form of boundary value analysis where we don't consider the 'single fault' assumption theory of reliability.
- Now, failures are also due to occurrence of more than one fault simultaneously.
- The restriction of one input value at any of the above mentioned values and other input values must be at nominal is not valid in worst-case testing.
- This will increase the number of test cases from  $4n + 1$  test cases to  $5^n$  test cases, where 'n' is the number of input values.
  - (i) Minimum value
  - (ii) Just above minimum value
  - (iii) Just below maximum value
  - (iv) Maximum value
  - (v) Nominal (Average) value

## 2.1.2 Worst-Case Testing

- The program 'Addition' will have  $5^2 = 25$  test cases and these test cases are given in Table 2.8





## 2.1.2 Worst-Case Testing

- The program 'Addition' will have  $5^2 = 25$  test cases and these test cases are given in Table 2.8

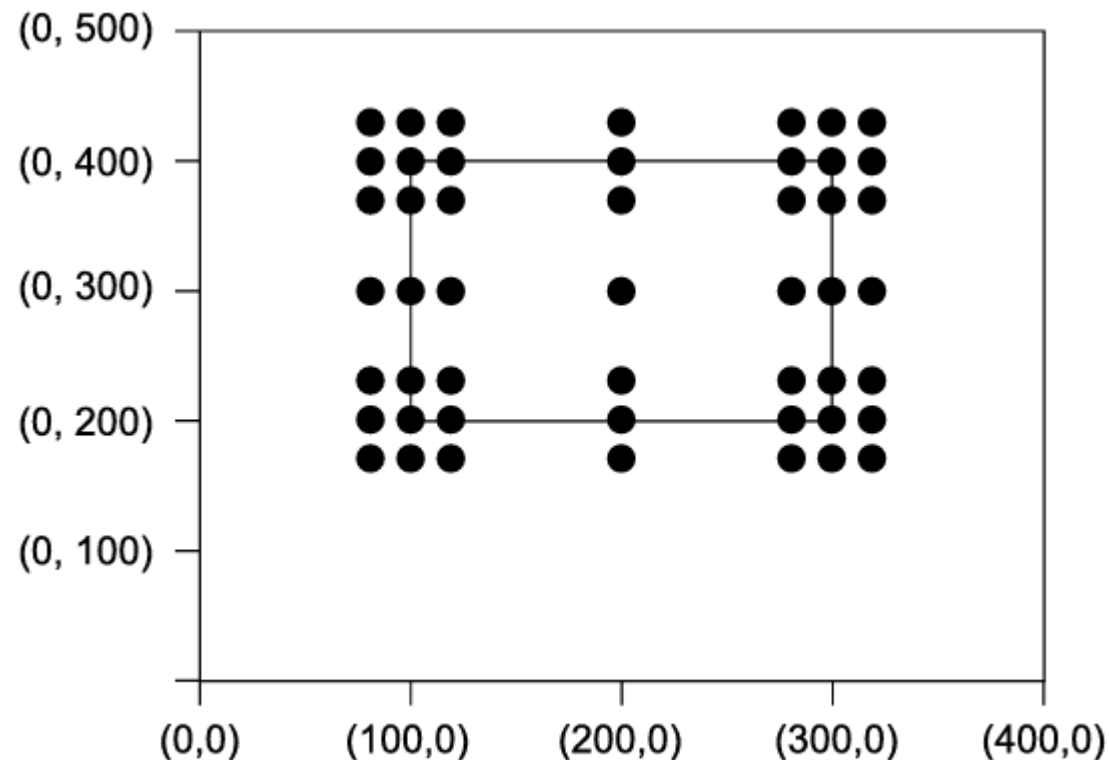
| Table 2.8. Worst test cases for the program 'Addition' |     |     |       | Test Case | x   | y |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|-------|-----------|-----|---|
| Test Case                                              | x   | y   | Expec |           |     |   |
| 1.                                                     | 100 | 200 | 300   | 15.       | 200 | 4 |
| 2.                                                     | 100 | 201 | 301   | 16.       | 299 | 2 |
| 3.                                                     | 100 | 300 | 400   | 17.       | 299 | 2 |
| 4.                                                     | 100 | 399 | 499   | 18.       | 299 | 3 |
| 5.                                                     | 100 | 400 | 500   | 19.       | 299 | 3 |
| 6.                                                     | 101 | 200 | 301   | 20.       | 299 | 4 |
| 7.                                                     | 101 | 201 | 302   | 21.       | 300 | 2 |
| 8.                                                     | 101 | 300 | 401   | 22.       | 300 | 2 |
| 9.                                                     | 101 | 399 | 500   | 23.       | 300 | 3 |
| 10.                                                    | 101 | 400 | 501   | 24.       | 300 | 3 |
| 11.                                                    | 200 | 200 | 400   | 25.       | 300 | 4 |
| 12.                                                    | 200 | 201 | 401   |           |     |   |
| 13.                                                    | 200 | 300 | 500   |           |     |   |
| 14.                                                    | 200 | 399 | 599   |           |     |   |

## 2.1.3 Robust Worst-Case Testing

- In robustness testing, we add two more states i.e. just below minimum value (minimum value−) and just above maximum value (maximum value+). We also give invalid inputs and observe the behaviour of the program.
- There are seven states (minimum −, minimum, minimum +, nominal, maximum −, maximum, maximum +)
- total of  $7^n$  test cases will be generated

## 2.1.3 Robust Worst-Case Testing

- The inputs for the program 'Addition' are graphically shown in Figure 2.8. The program 'Addition' will have  $7^2 = 49$  test cases and these test cases are shown in Table 2.9



## 2.1.3 Robust Worst-Case Testing

| Test Case | x   | y   | Expected Output |
|-----------|-----|-----|-----------------|
| 1.        | 99  | 199 | Invalid input   |
| 2.        | 99  | 200 | Invalid input   |
| 3.        | 99  | 201 | Invalid input   |
| 4.        | 99  | 300 | Invalid input   |
| 5.        | 99  | 399 | Invalid input   |
| 6.        | 99  | 400 | Invalid input   |
| 7.        | 99  | 401 | Invalid input   |
| 8.        | 100 | 199 | Invalid input   |
| 9.        | 100 | 200 | 300             |
| 10.       | 100 | 201 | 301             |
| 11.       | 100 | 300 | 400             |
| 12.       | 100 | 399 | 499             |
| 13.       | 100 | 400 | 500             |
| 14.       | 100 | 401 | Invalid input   |
| 15.       | 101 | 199 | Invalid input   |
| 16.       | 101 | 200 | 301             |
| 17.       | 101 | 201 | 302             |
| 18.       | 101 | 300 | 401             |
| 19.       | 101 | 399 | 500             |
| 20.       | 101 | 400 | 501             |
| 21.       | 101 | 401 | Invalid input   |
| 22.       | 200 | 199 | Invalid input   |
| 23.       | 200 | 200 | 400             |
| 24.       | 200 | 201 | 401             |
| 25.       | 200 | 300 | 500             |
| 26.       | 200 | 399 | 599             |
| 27.       | 200 | 400 | 600             |
| 28.       | 200 | 401 | Invalid input   |
| 29.       | 299 | 199 | Invalid input   |
| 30.       | 299 | 200 | 499             |
| 31.       | 299 | 201 | 500             |
| 32.       | 299 | 300 | 599             |
| 33.       | 299 | 399 | 698             |
| 34.       | 299 | 400 | 699             |
| 35.       | 299 | 401 | Invalid input   |
| 36.       | 300 | 199 | Invalid input   |
| 37.       | 300 | 200 | 500             |
| 38.       | 300 | 201 | 501             |
| 39.       | 300 | 300 | 600             |
| 40.       | 300 | 399 | 699             |
| 41.       | 300 | 400 | 700             |
| 42.       | 300 | 401 | Invalid input   |
| 43.       | 301 | 199 | Invalid input   |
| 44.       | 301 | 200 | Invalid input   |
| 45.       | 301 | 201 | Invalid input   |
| 46.       | 301 | 300 | Invalid input   |
| 47.       | 301 | 399 | Invalid input   |
| 48.       | 301 | 400 | Invalid input   |
| 49.       | 301 | 401 | Invalid input   |

## 2.1.4 Applicability

- Boundary value analysis is a simple technique and may prove to be effective when used correctly.
- Here, input values should be independent which restricts its applicability in many programs.
- This technique does not make sense for Boolean variables where input values are TRUE and FALSE only, and no choice is available for nominal values, just above boundary values, just below boundary values, etc.
- This technique can significantly reduce the number of test cases and is suited to programs in which input values are within ranges or within sets.
- This is equally applicable at the unit, integration, system and acceptance test levels. All we want is input values where boundaries can be identified from the requirements.

## 2. Equivalence Partitioning

This technique divides the input data of a program into logical "equivalence classes" or partitions. The idea is that if a test case works for one value in a partition, it will work for all values in that same partition. This helps reduce the total number of test cases.

- **Valid Equivalence Classes:** Inputs that are considered valid and accepted by the system.
- **Invalid Equivalence Classes:** Inputs that are considered invalid and should be rejected.

Example: A textbox for age (18-60)

- **Valid Class:** Numbers between 18 and 60 (e.g., 25, 40).
- **Invalid Class 1:** Numbers less than 18 (e.g., 17, 0).
- **Invalid Class 2:** Numbers greater than 60 (e.g., 61, 100).
- **Invalid Class 3:** Non-numeric values (e.g., "abc", "@").

## 2.2.1 Creation of Equivalence Classes

- The entire input domain can be divided into at least two equivalence classes: one containing all valid inputs and the other containing all invalid inputs.
- Each equivalence class can further be sub-divided into equivalence classes on which the program is required to behave differently.
- The input domain equivalence classes for the program 'Square' which takes 'x' as an input (range 1-100) and prints the square of 'x' (seen in Figure 2.2) are given as:

(i)  $I_1 = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 100 \}$  (Valid input range from 1 to 100)

(ii)  $I_2 = \{ x < 1 \}$  (Any invalid input where x is less than 1)

(iii)  $I_3 = \{ x > 100 \}$  (Any invalid input where x is greater than 100)

## 2.2.1 Creation of Equivalence Classes

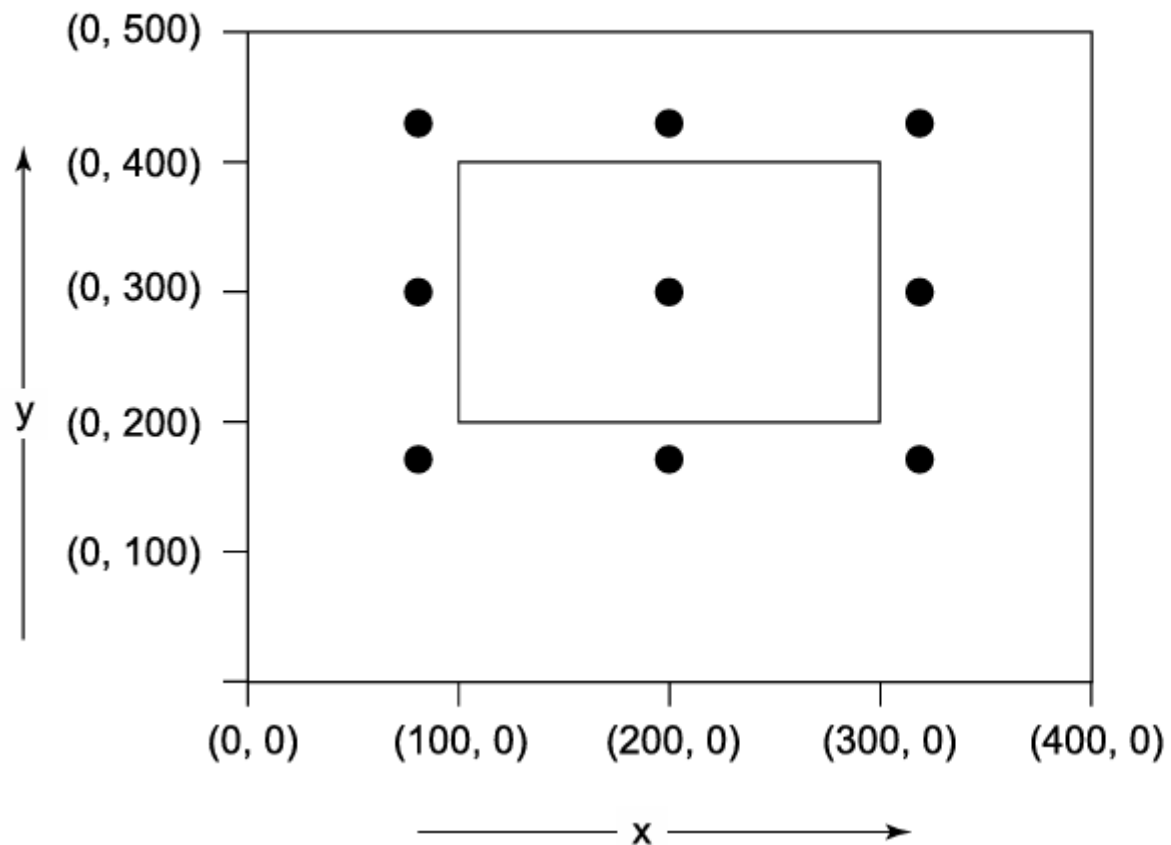
The following equivalence classes can be generated for program 'Addition' for input domain:

- (i)  $I_1 = \{ 100 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } 200 \leq y \leq 400 \}$  (Both x and y are valid values)
- (ii)  $I_2 = \{ 100 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } y < 200 \}$  (x is valid and y is invalid)
- (iii)  $I_3 = \{ 100 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } y > 400 \}$  (x is valid and y is invalid)
- (iv)  $I_4 = \{ x < 100 \text{ and } 200 \leq y \leq 400 \}$  (x is invalid and y is valid)
- (v)  $I_5 = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } 200 \leq y \leq 400 \}$  (x is invalid and y is valid)
- (vi)  $I_6 = \{ x < 100 \text{ and } y < 200 \}$  (Both inputs are invalid)
- (vii)  $I_7 = \{ x < 100 \text{ and } y > 400 \}$  (Both inputs are invalid)
- (viii)  $I_8 = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } y < 200 \}$  (Both inputs are invalid)
- (ix)  $I_9 = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } y > 400 \}$  (Both inputs are invalid)



## 2.2.1 Creation of Equivalence Classes

The graphical representation of inputs is shown in Figure 2.9 and the test cases are given in Table 2.19.



## 2.2.1 Creation of Equivalence Classes

**Table 2.19.** Test cases for the program 'Addition'

| Test Case      | x   | y   | Expected Output |
|----------------|-----|-----|-----------------|
| I <sub>1</sub> | 200 | 300 | 500             |
| I <sub>2</sub> | 200 | 199 | Invalid input   |
| I <sub>3</sub> | 200 | 401 | Invalid input   |
| I <sub>4</sub> | 99  | 300 | Invalid input   |
| I <sub>5</sub> | 301 | 300 | Invalid input   |
| I <sub>6</sub> | 99  | 199 | Invalid input   |
| I <sub>7</sub> | 99  | 401 | Invalid input   |
| I <sub>8</sub> | 301 | 199 | Invalid input   |
| I <sub>9</sub> | 301 | 401 | Invalid input   |

## 2.2.1 Creation of Equivalence Classes

- From output domain

$O_1 = \{\text{square of the input number 'x'}\}$

$O_2 = \{\text{Invalid input}\}$

**Table 2.20. Test cases for program 'Square' based on output domain**

| Test Case | Input x | Expected Output |
|-----------|---------|-----------------|
| $O_1$     | 50      | 2500            |
| $O_2$     | 0       | Invalid Input   |

$O_1 = \{\text{Addition of two input numbers x and y}\}$

$O_2 = \{\text{Invalid Input}\}$

**Table 2.21. Test cases for program 'Addition' based on output domain**

| Test Case | x   | y   | Expected Output |
|-----------|-----|-----|-----------------|
| $O_1$     | 200 | 300 | 500             |
| $O_2$     | 99  | 300 | Invalid Input   |

## 2.2.2 Applicability

- It is applicable at unit, integration, system and acceptance test levels.

**Example 2.9:** Consider the program for determination of the largest amongst three numbers specified in example 2.1. Identify the equivalence class test cases for output and input domain.

**Solution:** Output domain equivalence classes are:

$$O_1 = \{ \langle x, y, z \rangle : \text{Largest amongst three numbers } x, y, z \}$$

$$O_2 = \{ \langle x, y, z \rangle : \text{Input values(s) is /are out of range with sides } x, y, z \}$$

The test cases are given in Table 2.22.

| Table 2.22. Output domain test cases to find the largest among three numbers |     |     |     |                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|-----|-------------------------------|
| Test Case                                                                    | x   | y   | z   | Expected Output               |
| $O_1$                                                                        | 150 | 140 | 110 | 150                           |
| $O_2$                                                                        | 301 | 50  | 50  | Input values are out of range |

- $I_1 = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  (All inputs are valid)
- $I_2 = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  ( x is invalid , y is valid and z is valid)
- $I_3 = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  (x is valid, y is invalid and z is valid)
- $I_4 = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  (x is valid, y is valid and z is invalid)
- $I_5 = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  (x is invalid, y is valid and z is valid)
- $I_6 = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  (x is valid, y is invalid and z is valid)
- $I_7 = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  ( x is valid, y is valid and z is invalid)
- $I_8 = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  ( x is invalid, y is invalid and z is valid)
- $I_9 = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  (x is valid, y is invalid and z is invalid)
- $I_{10} = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  ( x is invalid, y is valid and z is invalid)
- $I_{11} = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  (x is invalid, y is invalid and z is valid)
- $I_{12} = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  ( x is valid, y is invalid and z is invalid)
- $I_{13} = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  ( x is invalid, y is valid and z is invalid)
- $I_{14} = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  ( x is invalid, y is invalid and z is valid)
- $I_{15} = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } 1 \leq z \leq 300 \}$  ( x is invalid, y is invalid and z is valid)
- $I_{16} = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  ( x is valid, y is invalid and z is invalid)

## 2.2.2 Applicability

$I_{17} = \{ 1 \leq x \leq 300 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  ( x is valid, y is invalid and z is invalid)

$I_{18} = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  (x is invalid, y is valid and z is invalid)

$I_{19} = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } 1 \leq y \leq 300 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  (x is invalid, y is valid and z is invalid)

$I_{20} = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  (All inputs are invalid)

$I_{21} = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  ( All inputs are invalid)

$I_{22} = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  (All inputs are invalid)

$I_{23} = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  (All inputs are invalid)

$I_{24} = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  (All inputs are invalid)

$I_{25} = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } z < 1 \}$  (All inputs are invalid)

$I_{26} = \{ x > 300 \text{ and } y < 1 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  (All inputs are invalid)

$I_{27} = \{ x < 1 \text{ and } y > 300 \text{ and } z > 300 \}$  (All inputs are invalid)

## 2.3 DECISION TABLE BASED TESTING

Decision table testing is used for systems with complex business logic that can be represented as conditions and actions. It provides a systematic way to identify all possible combinations of conditions and the resulting actions.

**Structure of a Decision Table:**

- **Conditions:** The inputs or states that influence the outcome.
- **Rules:** The columns representing all possible combinations of conditions.
- **Actions:** The outputs or actions that result from each rule.

## 2.3 DECISION TABLE BASED TESTING

| Table 2.30. Decision table |                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | Stubs                      Entries                                                                  |
| Condition                  | <div>c<sub>1</sub></div> <div>c<sub>2</sub></div> <div>c<sub>3</sub></div>                          |
| Action                     | <div>a<sub>1</sub></div> <div>a<sub>2</sub></div> <div>a<sub>3</sub></div> <div>a<sub>4</sub></div> |

### Four Portions

1. Condition Stubs
2. Condition Entries
3. Action Stubs
4. Action Entries



## 2.3.2 Limited Entry and Extended Entry Decision Tables

- The decision tables which use only binary conditions are known as limited entry decision tables.
- The decision tables which use multiple conditions where a condition may have many possibilities instead of only 'true' and 'false' are known as extended entry decision tables

| Table 2.31. Typical structure of a decision table |                |                |                |                |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| Stubs                                             | R <sub>1</sub> | R <sub>2</sub> | R <sub>3</sub> | R <sub>4</sub> |
| c <sub>1</sub>                                    | F              | T              | T              | T              |
| c <sub>2</sub>                                    | -              | F              | T              | T              |
| c <sub>3</sub>                                    | -              | -              | F              | T              |
| a <sub>1</sub>                                    | X              | X              |                | X              |
| a <sub>2</sub>                                    |                |                | X              |                |
| a <sub>3</sub>                                    | X              |                |                |                |

## 2.3.3 'DoNot Care' Conditions and Rule Count

**Table 2.32. Decision table for triangle problem**

|            |                                |    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|------------|--------------------------------|----|----|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Condition  | $c_1: a < b + c?$              | F  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
|            | $c_2: b < c + a?$              | -  | F  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
|            | $c_3: c < a + b?$              | -  | -  | F | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
|            | $c_4: a^2 = b^2 + c^2?$        | -  | -  | - | T | T | T | T | F | F | F | F |
|            | $c_5: a^2 > b^2 + c^2?$        | -  | -  | - | T | T | F | F | T | T | F | F |
|            | $c_6: a_2 < b_2 + c_2?$        | -  | -  | - | T | F | T | F | T | F | T | F |
| Rule Count |                                | 32 | 16 | 8 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| Action     | $a_1$ : Invalid triangle       | X  | X  | X |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|            | $a_2$ : Right angled triangle  |    |    |   |   |   |   | X |   |   |   |   |
|            | $a_3$ : Obtuse angled triangle |    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   | X |   |   |
|            | $a_4$ : Acute angled triangle  |    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | X |   |
|            | $a_5$ : Impossible             |    |    |   | X | X | X |   | X |   |   | X |

## 2.3.3 'DoNot Care' Conditions and Rule Count

### Impossible Conditions

| Table 2.32. Decision table for triangle problem |                                |    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----|----|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Condition                                       | $c_1: a < b + c?$              | F  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
|                                                 | $c_2: b < c + a?$              | -  | F  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
|                                                 | $c_3: c < a + b?$              | -  | -  | F | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
|                                                 | $c_4: a^2 = b^2 + c^2?$        | -  | -  | - | T | T | T | T | F | F | F | F |
|                                                 | $c_5: a^2 > b^2 + c^2?$        | -  | -  | - | T | T | F | F | T | T | F | F |
|                                                 | $c_6: a_2 < b_2 + c_2?$        | -  | -  | - | T | F | T | F | T | F | T | F |
| Rule Count                                      |                                | 32 | 16 | 8 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| Action                                          | $a_1$ : Invalid triangle       | X  | X  | X |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|                                                 | $a_2$ : Right angled triangle  |    |    |   |   |   |   | X |   |   |   |   |
|                                                 | $a_3$ : Obtuse angled triangle |    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   | X |   |   |
|                                                 | $a_4$ : Acute angled triangle  |    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | X |   |
|                                                 | $a_5$ : Impossible             |    |    |   | X | X | X |   | X |   |   | X |

## 2.3.5 Applicability

- Decision tables are popular in circumstances where an output is dependent on many conditions and a large number of decisions are required to be taken.
- They may also incorporate complex business rules and use them to design test cases.
- Every column of the decision table generates a test case.
- As the size of the program increases, handling of decision tables becomes difficult and cumbersome.
- In practice, they can be applied easily at unit level only. System testing and integration testing may not find its effective applications.

## 2.3.5 Applicability

**Table 2.33. Decision table**

|                       |     |     |    |    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|-----------------------|-----|-----|----|----|----|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $c_1: x \geq 1?$      | F   | T   | T  | T  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| $c_2: x \leq 300?$    | -   | F   | T  | T  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| $c_3: y \geq 1?$      | -   | -   | F  | T  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| $c_4: y \leq 300?$    | -   | -   | -  | F  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| $c_5: z \geq 1?$      | -   | -   | -  | -  | F  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| $c_6: z \leq 300?$    | -   | -   | -  | -  | -  | F | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| $c_7: x > y?$         | -   | -   | -  | -  | -  | - | T | T | T | T | F | F | F | F |
| $c_8: y > z?$         | -   | -   | -  | -  | -  | - | T | T | F | F | T | T | F | F |
| $c_9: z > x?$         | -   | -   | -  | -  | -  | - | T | F | T | F | T | F | T | F |
| Rule Count            | 256 | 128 | 64 | 32 | 16 | 8 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| $a_1$ : Invalid input | X   | X   | X  | X  | X  | X |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| $a_2$ : x is largest  |     |     |    |    |    |   |   | X |   | X |   |   |   |   |
| $a_3$ : y is largest  |     |     |    |    |    |   |   |   |   |   | X | X |   |   |
| $a_4$ : z is largest  |     |     |    |    |    |   |   |   | X |   |   |   | X |   |
| $a_5$ : Impossible    |     |     |    |    |    |   | X |   |   |   |   |   |   | X |

## 2.3.5 Applicability

**Table 2.34. Test cases of the given problem**

| <b>Test Case</b> | <b>x</b> | <b>y</b> | <b>z</b> | <b>Expected Output</b> |
|------------------|----------|----------|----------|------------------------|
| 1.               | 0        | 50       | 50       | Invalid marks          |
| 2.               | 301      | 50       | 50       | Invalid marks          |
| 3.               | 50       | 0        | 50       | Invalid marks          |
| 4.               | 50       | 301      | 50       | Invalid marks          |
| 5.               | 50       | 50       | 0        | Invalid marks          |
| 6.               | 50       | 50       | 301      | Invalid marks          |
| 7.               | ?        | ?        | ?        | Impossible             |
| 8.               | 150      | 130      | 110      | 150                    |
| 9.               | 150      | 130      | 170      | 170                    |
| 10.              | 150      | 130      | 140      | 150                    |
| 11.              | 110      | 150      | 140      | 150                    |
| 12.              | 140      | 150      | 120      | 150                    |
| 13.              | 120      | 140      | 150      | 150                    |
| 14.              | ?        | ?        | ?        | Impossible             |

|                   |      |     |     |     |    |    |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|-------------------|------|-----|-----|-----|----|----|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| : mark1 >= 0 ?    | F    | T   | T   | T   | T  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| : mark1 <= 100 ?  | -    | F   | T   | T   | T  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| : mark2 >= 0 ?    | -    | -   | F   | T   | T  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| : mark2 <= 100 ?  | -    | -   | -   | F   | T  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| : mark3 >= 0 ?    | -    | -   | -   | -   | F  | T  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| : mark3 <= 100?   | -    | -   | -   | -   | -  | F  | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T | T |
| : 0 ≤ avg ≤ 39 ?  | -    | -   | -   | -   | -  | T  | T | F | T | T | T | F | F | F | F | F | F | F | F | F | F |
| : 40 ≤ avg ≤ 49 ? | -    | -   | -   | -   | -  | -  | T | F | F | F | F | T | T | T | T | F | F | F | F | F | F |
| : 50 ≤ avg ≤ 59 ? | -    | -   | -   | -   | -  | -  | - | T | F | F | F | T | T | F | F | T | T | T | F | F | F |
| : 60 ≤ avg ≤ 74 ? | -    | -   | -   | -   | -  | -  | - | - | T | F | F | - | F | T | F | T | F | F | T | T | F |
| : avg ≥ 75 ?      | -    | -   | -   | -   | -  | -  | - | - | - | T | F | - | - | F | F | - | T | F | T | F | F |
| Rule Count        | 1024 | 512 | 256 | 128 | 64 | 32 | 8 | 4 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 4 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |

|                                   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |  |   |   |  |   |   |   |
|-----------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|--|---|---|--|---|---|---|
| : Invalid marks                   | X | X | X | X | X | X |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |  |   |   |  |   |   |   |
| : First division with distinction |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |  |   |   |  |   | X |   |
| : First division                  |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |  |   |   |  | X |   |   |
| : Second division                 |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |  |   | X |  |   |   |   |
| : Third division                  |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | X |  |   |   |  |   |   |   |
| : Fail                            |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | X |   |   |   |  |   |   |  |   |   |   |
| : Impossible                      |   |   |   |   |   |   | X | X | X | X |   | X | X | X |  | X | X |  | X |   | X |

## 2.3.5 Applicability

**Table 2.36. Test cases of the given problem**

| Test Case | mark1 | mark2 | mark3 | Expected Output                 |
|-----------|-------|-------|-------|---------------------------------|
| 1.        | -1    | 50    | 50    | Invalid marks                   |
| 2.        | 101   | 50    | 50    | Invalid marks                   |
| 3.        | 50    | -1    | 50    | Invalid marks                   |
| 4.        | 50    | 101   | 50    | Invalid marks                   |
| 5.        | 50    | 50    | -1    | Invalid marks                   |
| 6.        | 50    | 50    | 101   | Invalid marks                   |
| 7.        | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 8.        | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 9.        | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 10.       | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 11.       | 25    | 25    | 25    | Fail                            |
| 12.       | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 13.       | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 14.       | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 15.       | 45    | 45    | 45    | Third division                  |
| 16.       | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 17.       | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 18.       | 55    | 55    | 55    | Second division                 |
| 19.       | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |
| 20.       | 65    | 65    | 65    | First division                  |
| 21.       | 80    | 80    | 80    | First division with distinction |
| 22.       | ?     | ?     | ?     | Impossible                      |



## 2.3.5 Applicability

$$I_1 = \{ A1 : 0 \leq \text{mark1} \leq 100 \}$$

$$I_2 = \{ A2 : \text{mark1} < 0 \}$$

$$I_3 = \{ A3 : \text{mark1} > 100 \}$$

$$I_4 = \{ B1 : 0 \leq \text{mark2} \leq 100 \}$$

$$I_5 = \{ B2 : \text{mark2} < 0 \}$$

$$I_6 = \{ B3 : \text{mark2} > 100 \}$$

$$I_7 = \{ C1 : 0 \leq \text{mark3} \leq 100 \}$$

$$I_8 = \{ C2 : \text{mark3} < 0 \}$$

$$I_9 = \{ C3 : \text{mark3} > 100 \}$$

$$I_{10} = \{ D1 : 0 \leq \text{avg} \leq 39 \}$$

$$I_{11} = \{ D2 : 40 \leq \text{avg} \leq 49 \}$$

$$I_{12} = \{ D3 : 50 \leq \text{avg} \leq 59 \}$$

$$I_{13} = \{ D4 : 60 \leq \text{avg} \leq 74 \}$$

$$I_{14} = \{ D5 : \text{avg} \geq 75 \}$$

$$\begin{aligned} I_1 &= \{ A1 \\ I_2 &= \{ A2 \\ I_3 &= \{ A3 \\ I_4 &= \{ B1 \end{aligned}$$

### 2.3.5 Applicability

**Table 2.37. Extended entry decision table**

[illegible]

## 2.3.5 Applicability

**Table 2.38. Test cases of the given problem**

| <b>Test Case</b> | <b>mark1</b> | <b>mark2</b> | <b>mark3</b> | <b>Expected Output</b>          |
|------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|---------------------------------|
| 1.               | 25           | 25           | 25           | Fail                            |
| 2.               | 45           | 45           | 45           | Third Division                  |
| 3.               | 55           | 55           | 55           | Second Division                 |
| 4.               | 65           | 65           | 65           | First Division                  |
| 5.               | 80           | 80           | 80           | First Division with Distinction |
| 6.               | 50           | 50           | -            | Invalid marks                   |
| 7.               | 50           | 50           | 101          | Invalid marks                   |
| 8.               | 50           | -            | 50           | Invalid marks                   |
| 9.               | 50           | 101          | 50           | Invalid marks                   |
| 10.              | -            | 50           | 50           | Invalid marks                   |
| 11.              | 101          | 50           | 50           | Invalid marks                   |

# Decision table optimization

- 1. Rule Consolidation (The "Don't Care" Method)
  - The most common optimization is merging rules that result in the same action regardless of a specific condition's value.
  - We represent these with a dash - or an "X," signifying a "Don't Care" entry.
  - How it works: If Rule 1 and Rule 2 result in "Action A," and the only difference between them is that Condition 3 is "True" in one and "False" in the other, Condition 3 is irrelevant for that specific outcome.
  - Result: You can merge two columns into one, effectively halving the complexity of that specific logic branch.
- 2. Identify Mutually Exclusive ConditionsIn many systems, certain conditions cannot physically or logically occur at the same time.
  - Identifying these allows you to prune "impossible" columns immediately.
  - Example: If you have conditions for Is\_Under\_18 and Is\_Senior\_Citizen, they cannot both be "True." Optimization:
  - Remove all columns where both are "True." This drastically reduces the total count before you even start writing test cases.

# Decision table optimization example

- Let's use an **Auto Insurance Premium** logic. It's a classic example because it involves risk factors that often overlap, making it a prime candidate for "collapsing."
- **The Requirements**
- **Age < 25:** Young drivers are higher risk.
- **Accident History:** Any accident in the last 3 years.
- **High-Performance Car:** Sports cars increase the premium.
- **Business Rules:**
- If the driver is young **AND** has an accident history, **Reject** the policy (regardless of car type).
- If the driver is 25+ with no accidents and a standard car, **Standard Rate**.
- Any other combination of "High Risk" factors (Young, Accident, or Sports Car) results in a **Surcharge**.

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- If the driver is young **AND** has an accident history, **Reject** the policy (regardless of car type).
- If the driver is 25+ with no accidents and a standard car, **Standard Rate**.
- Any other combination of "High Risk" factors (Young, Accident, or Sports Car) results in a **Surcharge**.

# Decision table optimization example

| Conditions            | R1 | R2 | R3 | R4 | R5 | R6 | R7 | R8 |
|-----------------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| C1: Age < 25?         | Y  | Y  | Y  | Y  | N  | N  | N  | N  |
| C2: Accident History? | Y  | Y  | N  | N  | Y  | Y  | N  | N  |
| C3: Sports Car?       | Y  | N  | Y  | N  | Y  | N  | Y  | N  |
| Actions               |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| A1: Standard Rate     |    |    |    |    |    |    |    | X  |
| A2: Surcharge         |    |    | X  | X  | X  | X  | X  |    |
| A3: Reject            | X  | X  |    |    |    |    |    |    |

# Decision table optimization example

- To optimize, we look for rules that have the same outcome where one condition doesn't actually change that outcome.
- **Look at R1 and R2:** Both result in "Reject." The only difference is the Sports Car (C3). This means if you are young and have accidents, we don't care what car you drive.
- **Look at R5 and R6:** Both result in "Surcharge." The only difference is the Sports Car (C3). If you have accidents and are over 25, you get a surcharge regardless of the car.
- **Look at R3 and R4:** Both result in "Surcharge." However, we have to be careful here—if we collapse these, we might lose the distinction of the car type. Wait, actually, if you are young and have *no* accidents, you get a surcharge regardless of the car (one for being young, or one for the car).



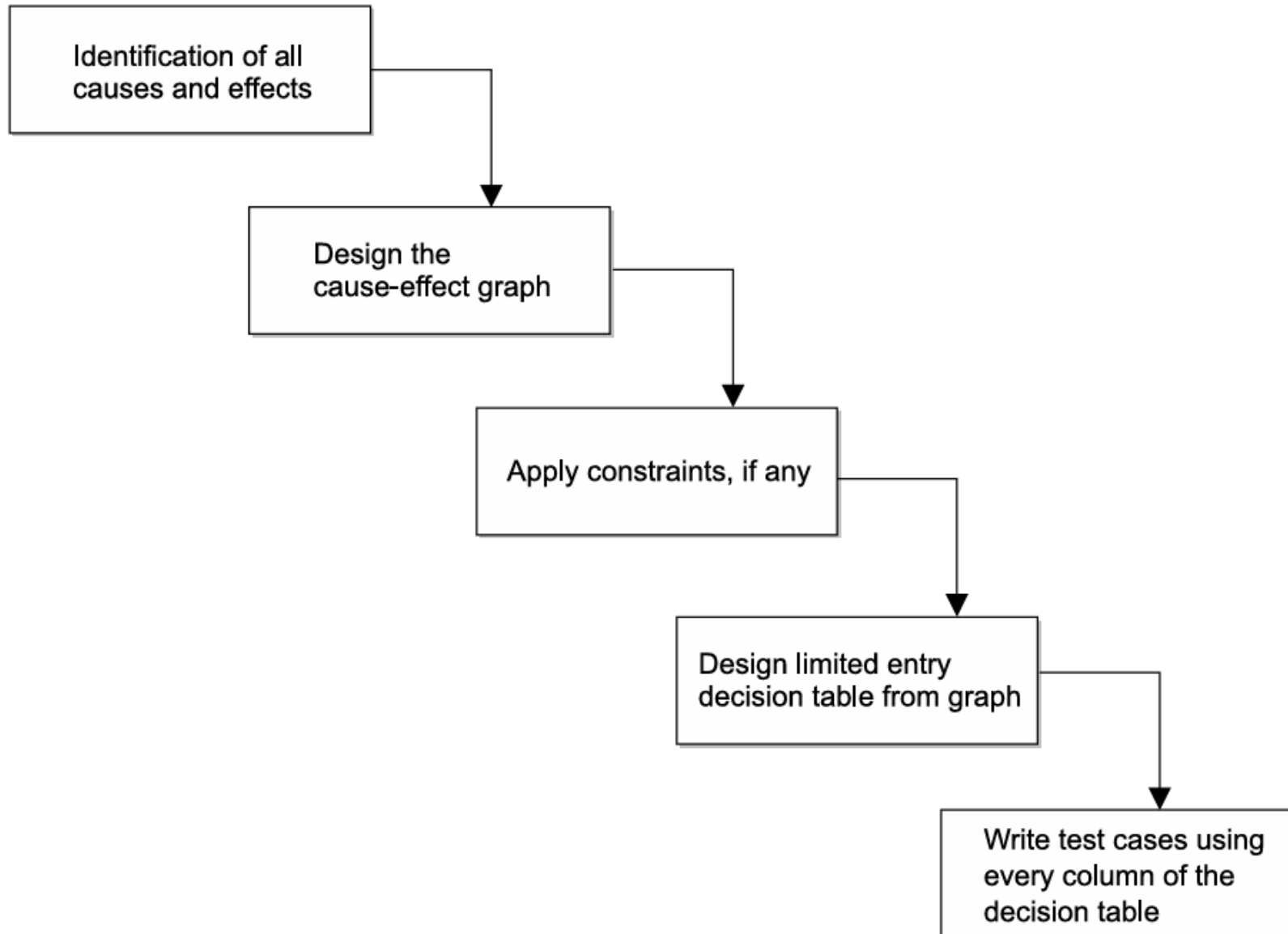
# Decision table optimization example

| Conditions            | Rule A | Rule B | Rule C | Rule D | Rule E |
|-----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| C1: Age < 25?         | Y      | Y      | N      | N      | N      |
| C2: Accident History? | Y      | N      | Y      | N      | N      |
| C3: Sports Car?       | —      | —      | —      | Y      | N      |
| Actions               |        |        |        |        |        |
| A1: Standard Rate     |        |        |        |        | X      |
| A2: Surcharge         |        | X      | X      | X      |        |
| A3: Reject            | X      |        |        |        |        |

# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE

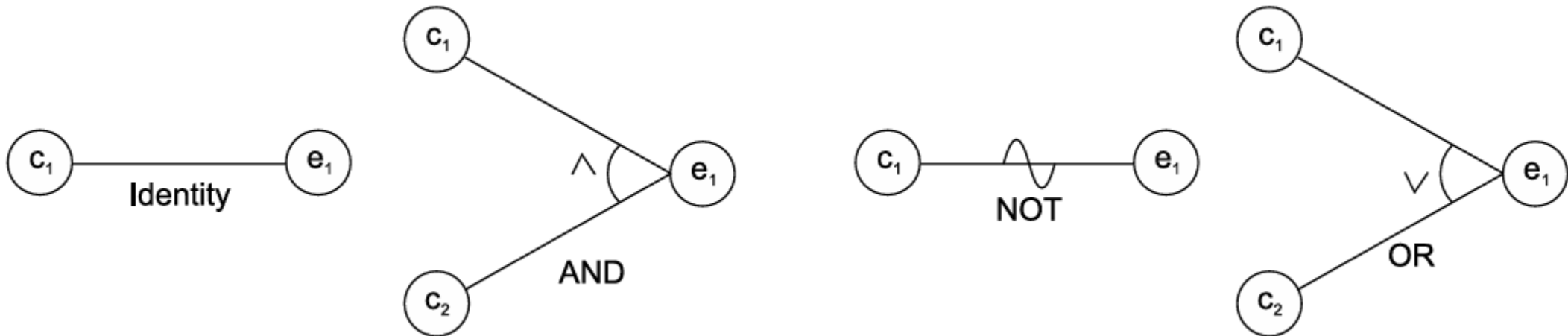
- This technique is a popular technique for small programs and considers the combinations of various inputs which were not available in earlier discussed techniques like boundary value analysis and equivalence class testing.
- Such techniques do not allow combinations of inputs and consider all inputs as independent inputs.
- Two new terms are used here and these are causes and effects, which are nothing but inputs and outputs respectively.

# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE



# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE

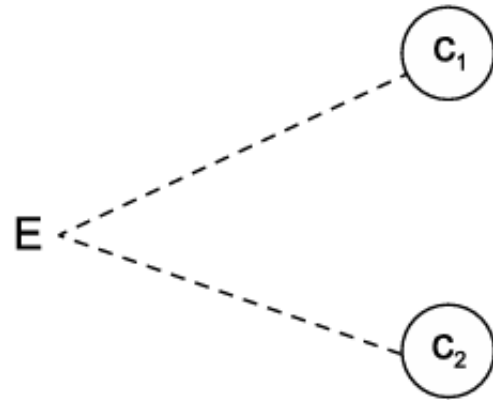
- Identification of Causes and Effects
  - The SRS document is used for the identification of causes and effects.
- Design of Cause-Effect Graph
  - The relationship amongst causes and effects are established using cause-effect graph. The basic notations of the graph



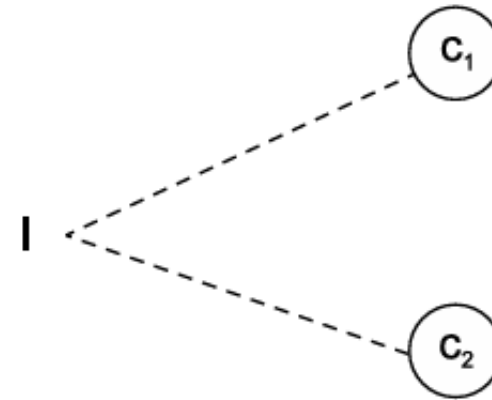
# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE

- Use of Constraints in Cause-Effect Graph
  - Exclusive The Exclusive (E) constraint states that at most one of  $c_1$  or  $c_2$  can be 1 ( $c_1$  or  $c_2$  cannot be 1 simultaneously). However, both  $c_1$  and  $c_2$  can be 0 simultaneously.
  - Inclusive The Inclusive (I) constraints states that at least one of  $c_1$  or  $c_2$  must always be 1. Hence, both cannot be 0 simultaneously. However, both can be 1.
  - One and Only One The one and only one (O) constraint states that one and only one of  $c_1$  and  $c_2$  must be 1
  - Requires The requires (R) constraint states that for  $c_1$  to be 1,  $c_2$  must be 1; it is impossible for  $c_1$  to be 1 if  $c_2$  is 0.
  - Mask This constraint is applicable at the effect side of the cause-effect graph. This states that if effect  $e_1$  is 1, effect  $e_2$  is forced to be 0.

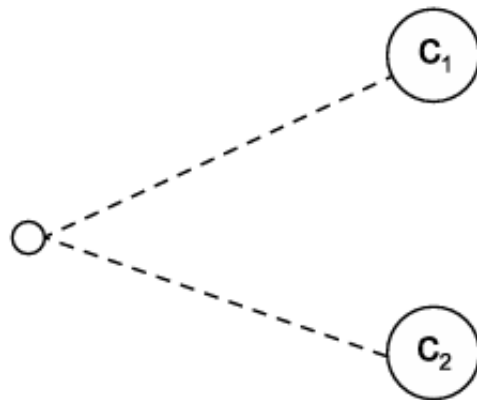
# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE



Exclusive



Inclusive



One and only one



Requires



Masks

# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE

- Consider the example of keeping the record of marital status and number of children of a citizen.
  - The value of marital status must be 'U' or 'M'.
  - The value of the number of children must be digit or null in case a citizen is unmarried.
  - If the information entered by the user is correct then an update is made.
  - If the value of marital status of the citizen is incorrect, then the error message 1 is issued.
  - Similarly, if the value of number of children is incorrect, then the error message 2 is issued.

# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE

- Consider the example of keeping the record of marital status and number of children of a citizen.

The causes are:

$c_1$ : marital status is 'U'

$c_2$ : marital status is 'M'

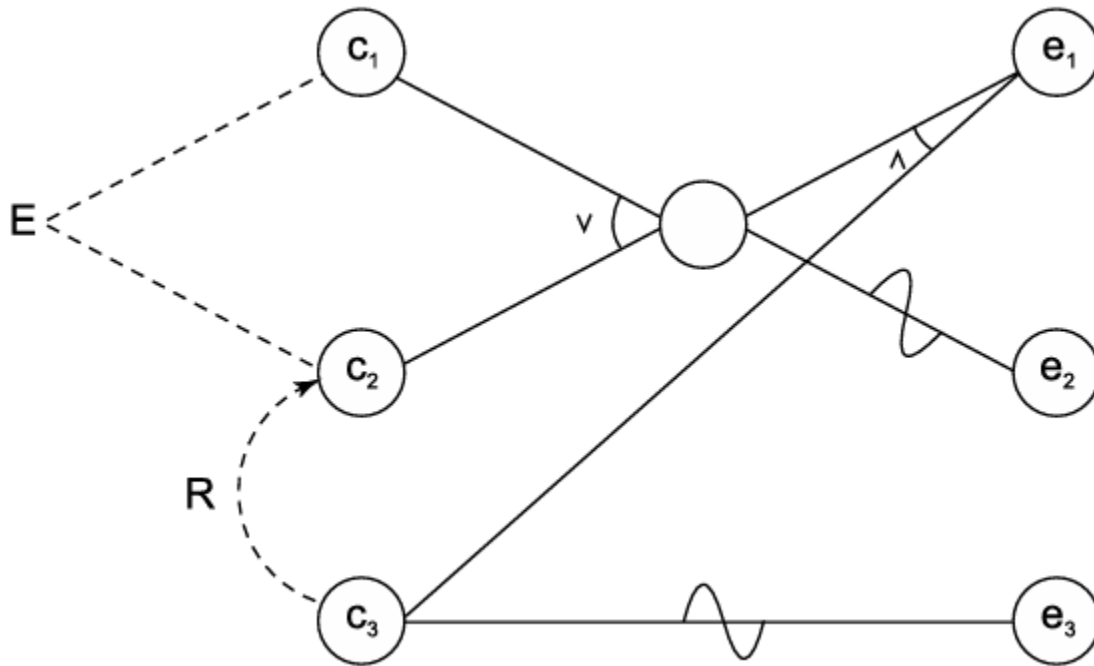
$c_3$ : number of children is a digit

and the effects are:

$e_1$ : updation made

$e_2$ : error message 1 is issued

$e_3$ : error message 2 is issued

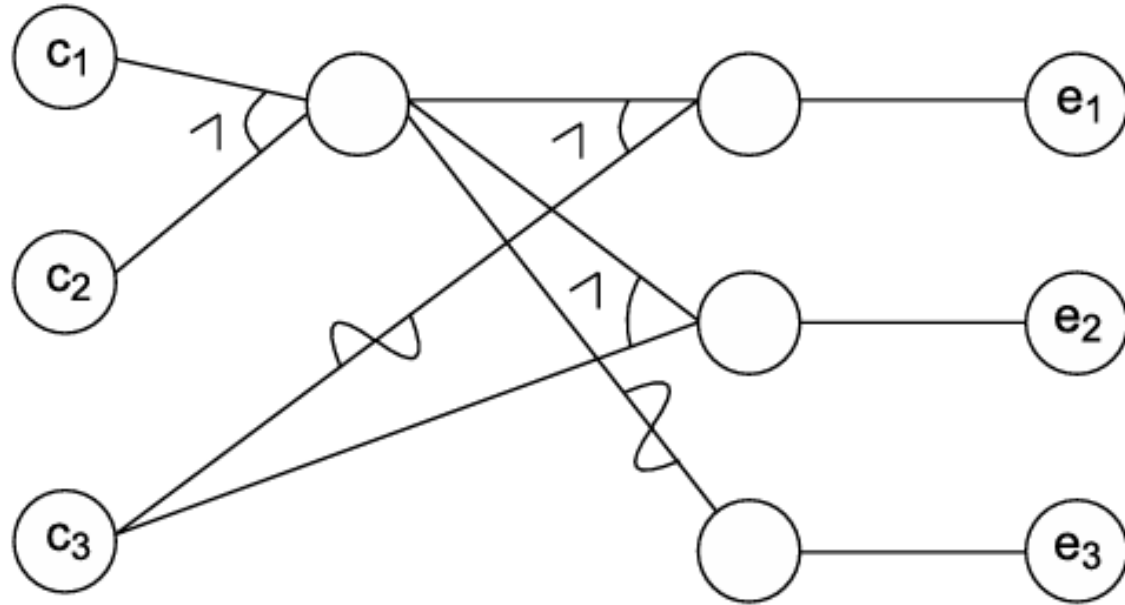




# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE

- A tourist of age greater than 21 years and having a clean driving record is supplied a rental car. A premium amount is also charged if the tourist is on business, otherwise it is not charged.
- If the tourist is less than 21 year old, or does not have a clean driving record, the system will display the following message: “Car cannot be supplied”

# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE



**Solution:** The causes are

$c_1$ : Age is over 21

$c_2$ : Driving record is clean

$c_3$ : Tourist is on business

and effects are

$e_1$ : Supply a rental car without premium charge.

$e_2$ : Supply a rental car with premium charge

$e_3$ : Car cannot be supplied

# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE

**Table 2.45. Decision table of rental car problem**

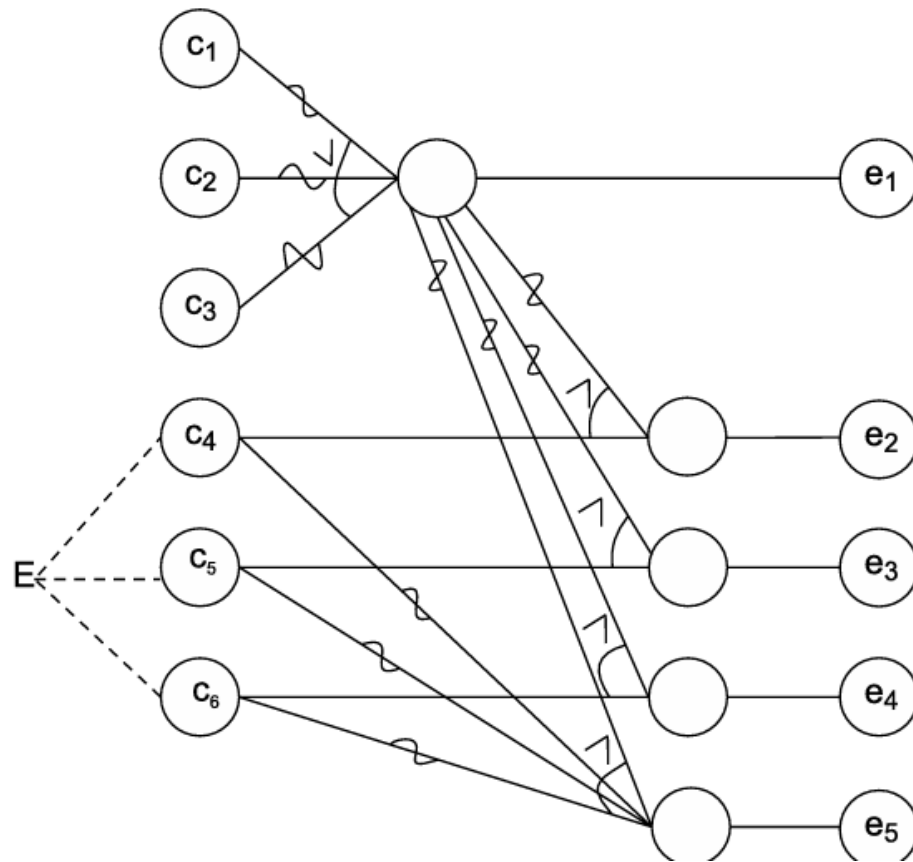
| Conditions                                         | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|----------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|
| $c_1$ : Over 21 ?                                  | F | T | T | T |
| $c_2$ : Driving record clean ?                     | - | F | T | T |
| $c_3$ : On Business ?                              | - | - | F | T |
| $e_1$ : Supply a rental car without premium charge |   |   | X |   |
| $e_2$ : Supply a rental car with premium charge    |   |   |   | X |
| $e_3$ : Car cannot be supplied                     | X | X |   |   |

**Table 2.46. Test cases of the given decision table**

| Test Case | Age | Driving_record_clean | On_business | Expected Output                            |
|-----------|-----|----------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 1.        | 20  | Yes                  | Yes         | Car cannot be supplied                     |
| 2.        | 26  | No                   | Yes         | Car cannot be supplied                     |
| 3.        | 62  | Yes                  | No          | Supply a rental car without premium charge |
| 4.        | 62  | Yes                  | Yes         | Supply a rental car with premium charge.   |

# CAL

|                                |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|--------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $c_1 : a < b + c$              | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| $c_2 : b < a + c$              | X | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| $c_3 : c < a + b$              | X | X | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| $c_4 : a^2 = b^2 + c^2$        | X | X | X | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| $c_5 : a^2 > b^2 + c^2$        | X | X | X | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 |
| $c_6 : a^2 < b^2 + c^2$        | X | X | X | 1 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 1 | 0 |
| $e_1$ : Invalid Triangle       | 1 | 1 | 1 |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| $e_2$ : Right angled Triangle  |   |   |   |   |   |   | 1 |   |   |   |   |
| $e_3$ : Obtuse angled triangle |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | 1 |   |   |
| $e_4$ : Acute angled triangle  |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | 1 |   |
| $e_5$ : Impossible             |   |   |   | 1 | 1 | 1 |   | 1 |   |   | 1 |



# CAUSE-EFFECT GRAPHING TECHNIQUE VS DECISION BASED TESTING

- Representation: Tabular vs. Graphical
- The Process Flow (The "Pre-requisite" Relationship)
  - **Cause-Effect Graphing** is often a **pre-step**. You create the graph to visualize and analyze the logical dependencies between inputs.
  - The **Decision Table** is the **result** of the graph. Once the graph is drawn, you convert it into a decision table to derive the actual test cases.
- Handling Constraints (E, I, O, R)
  - **Cause-Effect Graphing**: It has explicit notation for constraints between causes and effects.
- Logic Discovery
  - **Decision Tables**: These are best when the requirements are already clear and the combinations are straightforward
  - **Cause-Effect Graphing**: This is a **discovery tool**. It helps the tester find contradictions or ambiguities in the requirements.